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Web 2.0

What is Web 2.0?
Web 2.0 is a term often applied to the perceived ongoing transition of the World Wide Web from a collection of Web sites to a full-fledged computing platform serving Web applications to end users. Ultimately, Web 2.0 services are expected to replace desktop computing applications for many purposes. If Netscape was the standard bearer for Web 1.0, it's Google for Web 2.0.

Where is Web 2.0?
Web 2.0 is not a physical entity, but is, rather, the way the Web will be used in the future. For instance, Google started its life as a Web entity and has remained so ever since. It never created any products that could be shipped physically. Its income was generated through users—directly or indirectly—and will continue to do so. Moreover, the integration of its services is a good example of what the Web 2.0 definition encapsulates.

Who is running Web 2.0?
Web 2.0 is not a piece of software; it refers to the way an application or service or domain exists on the Web.

Why do we need Web 2.0?
Web 2.0 is about 'glocalisation'—making global information available to local social contexts and giving people the flexibility to find, organise, share and create information in a locally meaningful fashion that is globally accessible.

When will Web 2.0 be available?
Look at Web 2.0 as a set of compliance guidelines. There already exist sites that comply with these, for example, Flickr.

How is it different from what we have now?
The technology infrastructure of Web 2.0 is complex and evolving, but includes server software, content syndication, messaging protocols, standards-based browsers, and various client applications.

areas stricken by a disaster. David Grace from the University of York, one of the project scientists behind the test, says stratospheric communications balloons can indeed provide wireless alternatives to fixed Internet infrastructures.

The main concern with balloons as communications hubs is ensuring they don't interfere with commercial aircraft. Controllers on the ground can alter the altitude of the balloon, but they can't steer it—as of now.

The consortium is also looking to develop other types of communications craft that can fly at very high altitudes. Craft such as airships could be useful when heavier communication equipment such as radio antennas need to be carried to the skies.

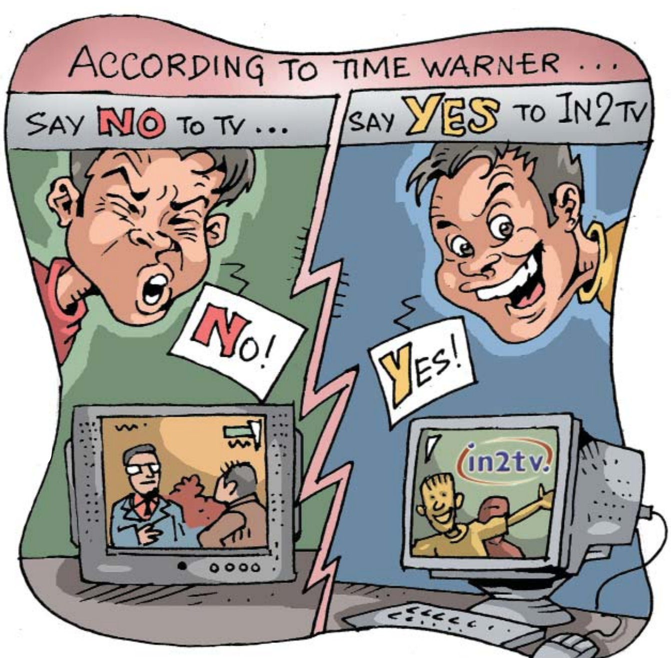
SOAPS ON YOUR PC

Net TV As Early As 2006?

Media giant Time Warner has announced they will be launching Internet television as early as 2006. In a bid to beat Internet companies such as Yahoo! and Google, who are planning to use computers and the Internet to relay television shows, Time Warner is readying to launch In2TV.

This ad-supported Internet TV model will have six channels, comprising the comedy, drama, animation, action, classic and superhero/villain genres. With 4,800 episodes of various shows and over 3,000 hours of programming, the Internet TV model has a huge bank of ready content to go live. The company plans to show already-aired episodes to start off before conceiving original content for this medium.

Time Warner also hopes to sell Microsoft a stake in this venture. The move to non-traditional media for airing television shows has been on the anvil for a couple of years now, and the advent of the Video iPod and podcasting has only quickened the pace of development in this area. So the next time your mom tunes into your computer to watch her daily soap you know which plug to pull!



CHEAPER PRINTS NOW GET DONE QUICK

HP's New Printing Technology

Late last month, HP launched the Officejet Pro K550 colour printer. This, HP claims, is the fastest printer in its category. HP also launched a photo printer for home users—the HP Photosmart 8238, which can print high quality colour photographs in 14 seconds.

What's interesting here is that both ranges of printers incorporate technology that HP claims is revolutionary as far as the printing and imaging industry is concerned. Designed using what HP calls Scalable Printing Technology, these printers have print heads that have been created photolithographically. This process of creating nozzles in the print head has been borrowed from the chip fabrication process. It ensures that the cost of printing comes down by almost half.

HP has designed a kind of common core for all print heads, thus making sure that the cost for manufacturing them in bulk comes down—and thus the price of the printer, too, comes down.

The photo printer features six separate ink cartridges. The printer also incorporates a smart printing technology that ensures no print job is left half done.

Digit is yet to test HP's claims, and we're hoping to get our hands on one of these printers soon! ⊠

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